

Each of these schools of economic thought was a product of its time but many of the principles can still be applied today. Economists can look back on which of these theories has proved to work best in the real world, and adapt and improve upon them.



## IS ECONOMICS A SCIENCE?

Many economists have considered their subject as a kind of science. But economics is not a “hard science” like physics. Money is not a natural phenomenon, but a human invention, shaped by our behavior and influenced by political ideas.

Economics is not an exact science—it can be hard to prove a theory right or wrong.



“Economics” comes from the Greek meaning “household management.”

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